

you, and the negative motives, if they touch you, will not harm you if you remember: The surest way of finding peace of mind is the way which helps the greatest number of others to find it.

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When You Are Free of Fear, You Are Free to Live

Free yourself of fear, and you free yourself of a man-made devil. Seven major fears reinforce each other: the fear of poverty, the fear of criticism, the fear of ill health, the fear of loss of love, the fear of loss of liberty, the fear of old age, the fear of death. Separate your self-made fears from the fears which are necessary for self-preservation. Make way for self-confident faith in yourself, the indispensable ingredient of a life worth living.

WHEN you fear something, that thing is more likely to find you and harm you.

When you look a threat in the eye and *know* you are going to overcome it—that is when great powers come to your aid.

Fear, the most powerful of negative motives, is like prayer in reverse. Instead of appealing to the constructive forces which surround us, it appeals to the forces of destruction. It becomes a god in itself, demanding endless painful sacrifices. People rarely will admit that lives of bitter privation may be founded on nothing more than constant fear—and yet you can see it happen all around you.

The first fear I shall mention is a terribly “magnetic” fear. The more of it you have, the more you are likely to attract.

1. The fear of poverty. Now and again I have had occasion to meet people I knew in my own poverty-stricken youth. Of late I have been meeting their now-grown children. When I have known both parent and child I often can trace the persistence of a kind of family fondness for poverty. Fearing poverty with good reason as it ground them down—hating it and protesting it—such families have nevertheless allowed